

1 Downloading and Installing Git Bash on Windows

1.1 What is Git Bash?

Git Bash is a terminal application for Windows that lets you run Git commands (and many Unix-style commands like `ls`, `cd`, `ssh-keygen`) using a Bash shell, instead of the default Windows Command Prompt.

1.2 Download the Installer

1. Open a web browser and go to <https://git-scm.com/downloads>.
2. Click **Windows** under the list of operating systems.
3. The download should start automatically. If not, click the manual download link for the latest 64-bit version.

1.3 Run the Installer

1. Locate the downloaded file (usually named something like `Git-2.xx.x-64-bit.exe`) in your **Downloads** folder and double-click it.
2. If prompted by Windows “Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?”, click **Yes**.
3. Click **Next** on the license screen.

1.4 Installation Options

The installer presents several configuration screens. For most beginners, the default options are fine — just keep clicking **Next**. A few worth knowing about:

- **Select Components:** default checkboxes are fine.
- **Choosing the default editor:** pick whichever text editor you’re comfortable with (Notepad is a safe choice for beginners).
- **Adjusting your PATH environment:** choose “Git from the command line and also from 3rd-party software” (this is usually the recommended/default option).
- **Choosing the SSH executable:** use the bundled OpenSSH (default option).
- **Configuring the line ending conversions:** keep the default (“Checkout Windows-style, commit Unix-style line endings”).
- **Configuring terminal emulator:** use MinTTY (default option).

1.5 Finish Installation

1. Click **Install** and wait for the process to complete.
2. Click **Finish**.

1.6 Open Git Bash

1. Right-click anywhere on your Desktop or inside a folder, and select **Git Bash Here** from the context menu.
2. Alternatively, click the **Start** menu, search for “Git Bash”, and open the application.

1.7 Verify the Installation

In the Git Bash window that opens, type:

```
git --version
```

You should see output similar to:

```
git version 2.45.1.windows.1
```

If a version number appears, Git Bash is installed correctly and you’re ready to use commands like `git clone`, `ssh-keygen`, and `ssh -T git@github.com`.